Platforms I Am Working On(Priority Wise)

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1. Reddit

    - It's a platform where discussions happen on specific topics, so chances of finding conversational data here were maximum among other platforms.

    - Here you can find conversational data in posts as text where people describe scams that happened to them and also add images(of conversations) for proof.

    - And if not describing the scam themselves, if they post about a scam they add a title like “I got scammed”, “Work From Home Scam”,.etc and post only images as proof.

    - Either way it's a win-win for my strategy.

2. X/Twitter

    - On day 1 of this **data collection hackathon** I started with twitter as my first platform but it turned out not many people post their whole conversations in tweets.

    - But people still tweet about them getting scammed by tweeting a little description of the event or conversation in the tweet along with **images as proof.**

    - We can use the same strategy as used on the reddit app to identify conversation in the images and convert them in proper text format.

    - Why I started with X/Twitter:
        Two days before the hackathon started I figured out **(and Had the code ready)** how to fetch thousands of tweets From X without hitting **rate limits** or paying **high API subscription charges**.

3. Telegram

- I tested this platform as well and had written the code to fetch conversations from public channels.

- **What went wrong then** ?
    1. It was very hard to find channels that can have scam related images or conversations in it.

    2. Finding channels with scam descriptions or conversations of people on telegram is analogically similar to finding subreddits like **r/Scams** and **r/isthisascam** on reddit.
       But the problem is you can't find each individual's chat just like you can find each post(having even post_id) with a title on reddit.

    3. Even if you find channels with scam conversations, knowing from where each conversation started is very difficult to achieve and complex as well.

4. Instagram

- This platform focuses more on the personal image of users than issues and events like **X and Reddit** does.
  So it's hard to find scam conversations, that too in text or images.

Fraud Categories That I am Targeting

- On Reddit I targeted *Work From Home Scams, Loan Scams, Wrong Number Scams(Impersonation Scams)*.
- More Such categories that I will work on in *Romance Scams*, *Support Scams*.
- **The Scams I am choosing are the ones that happen more through messaging platforms.**

Handling Multilingual Conversations

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1. If my approach works well enough to get conversational data from images, then **we can simply identify identified texts's language using Google Translate API**
2. If we can use a VPN to change our location on these platforms and change language in which we want our content and interact with more language specific content we will get the same content as a person sitting in that region/country would get.
3. And then we can use the same method of fetching images and extracting conversations from them.